Countering Disinformation with
SOURCE
Crawling
Classification
Contextualization
Community-Building

SOURCE: Scalable,Open and Comprehensive Recognition of Disinformation Campaigns on the Web

Prof. Dr. Michael Granitzer
Chair of Data Science, University of Passau · Coordinator SOURCE

Funded by

Partners

1 · SOURCE in brief

DESINFORMATION ERKENNEN. DEMOKRATIE SCHÜTZEN.

SOURCE at a glance

SOURCE aims to build an **early-warning platform** against disinformation: web and social-media content is found and analysed for detecting disinformation campaigns and prepare corresponding countermeasures.

- analyses content by **where it comes from** and by **what it says**
- detects AI-generated material, manipulative language and factual errors
- builds on the **Open Web Index** of OpenWebSearch.eu
- open data, open interfaces, and a community around them



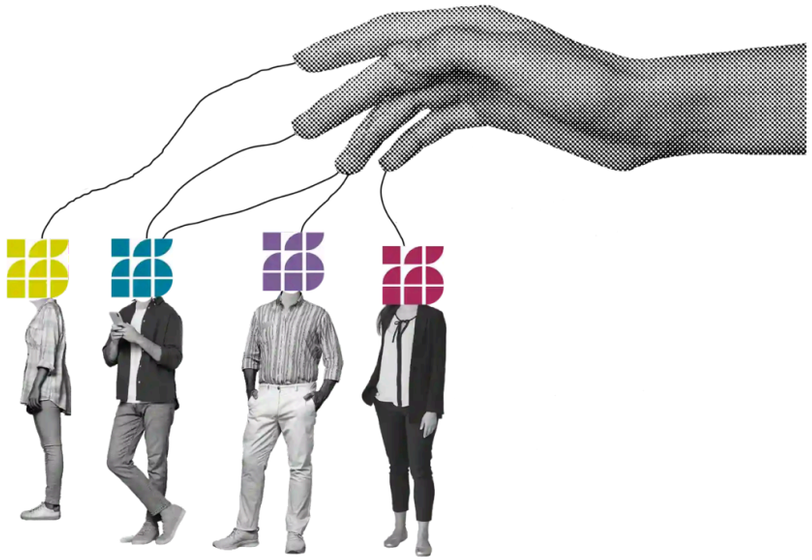
3 years
April 2026 – March 2029

€ 2.5 M
funded by the BMFTR

5 partners
research, infrastructure, civil society

source-project.de/projekt

Countering disinformation campaigns



A single false post is hardly a problem. What does the damage is the **campaign** behind it:

- the same story, slightly changed, on many sites and channels
- accounts that amplify each other, across platforms
- timing that follows a plan, not the news

Unfortunately, disinformation campaigns happen at scale.

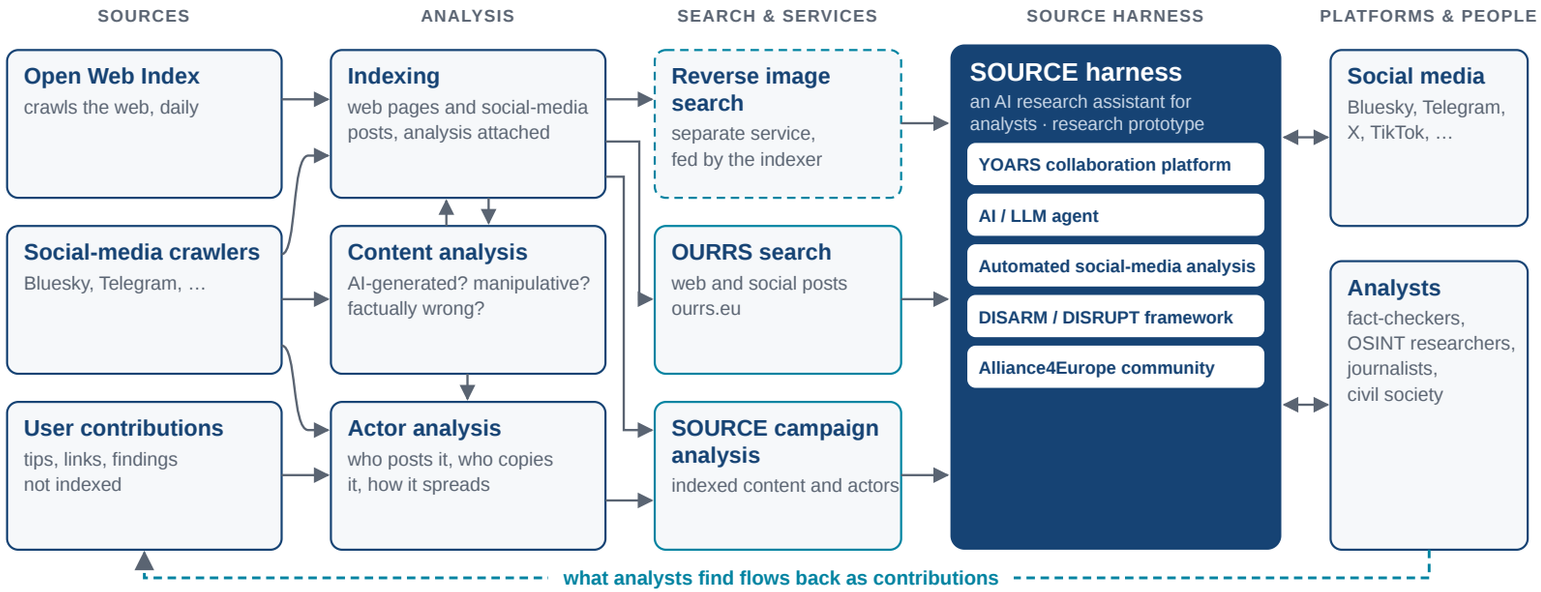
Countering a campaign require data, infrastructure, AI and, most importantly, a community. SOURCE aims to bring all elements together.

The consortium

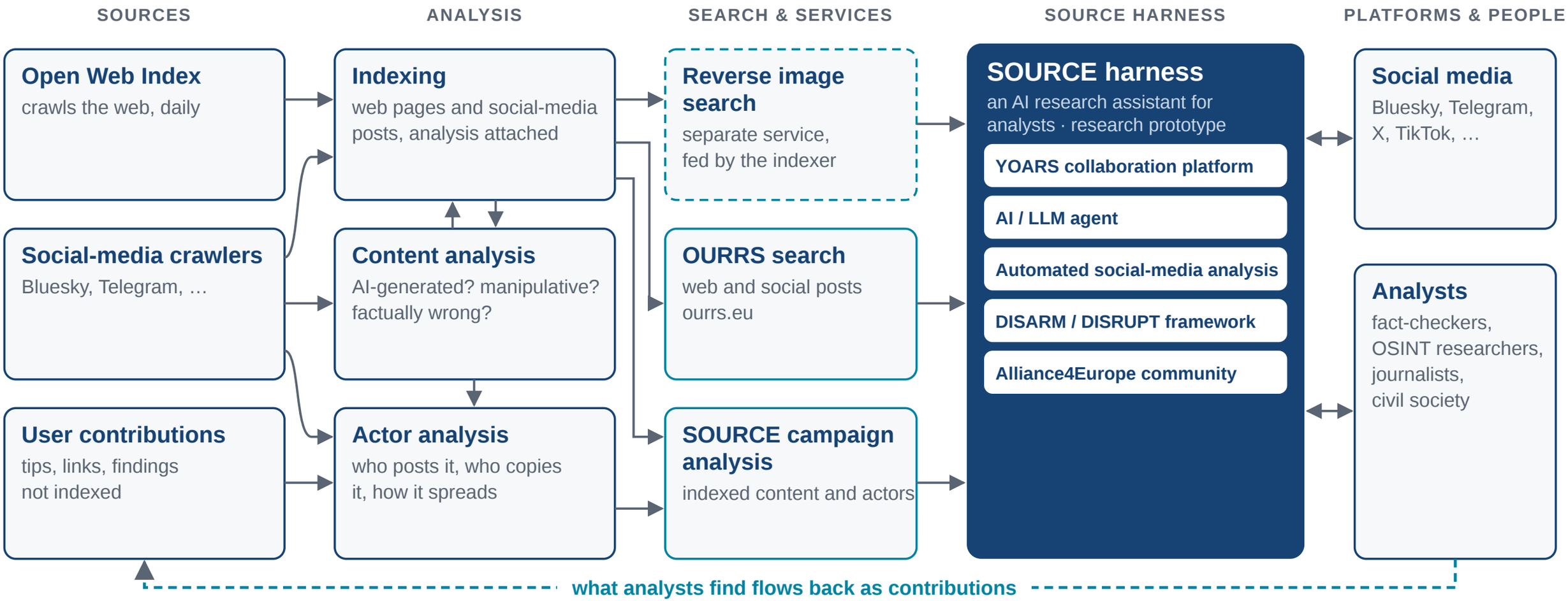
Partner	Focus in SOURCE
University of Passau · Data Science	coordination; source-based detection: finding and tracking content on the web, actors and networks
University of Kassel · Deep Semantic Learning	content-based detection: AI-generated text, stylometry and authorship, evaluation
Open Search Foundation	building and connecting the communities around the tools; science communication
LRZ · Leibniz Supercomputing Centre	compute, cloud and storage for the SOURCE database; federated infrastructure
Alliance4Europe	use cases and expert studies; the Counter Disinformation Network; integration into DISARM /DISRUPT

2 · Planned system

FROM THE OPEN WEB TO THE ANALYST, AND BACK



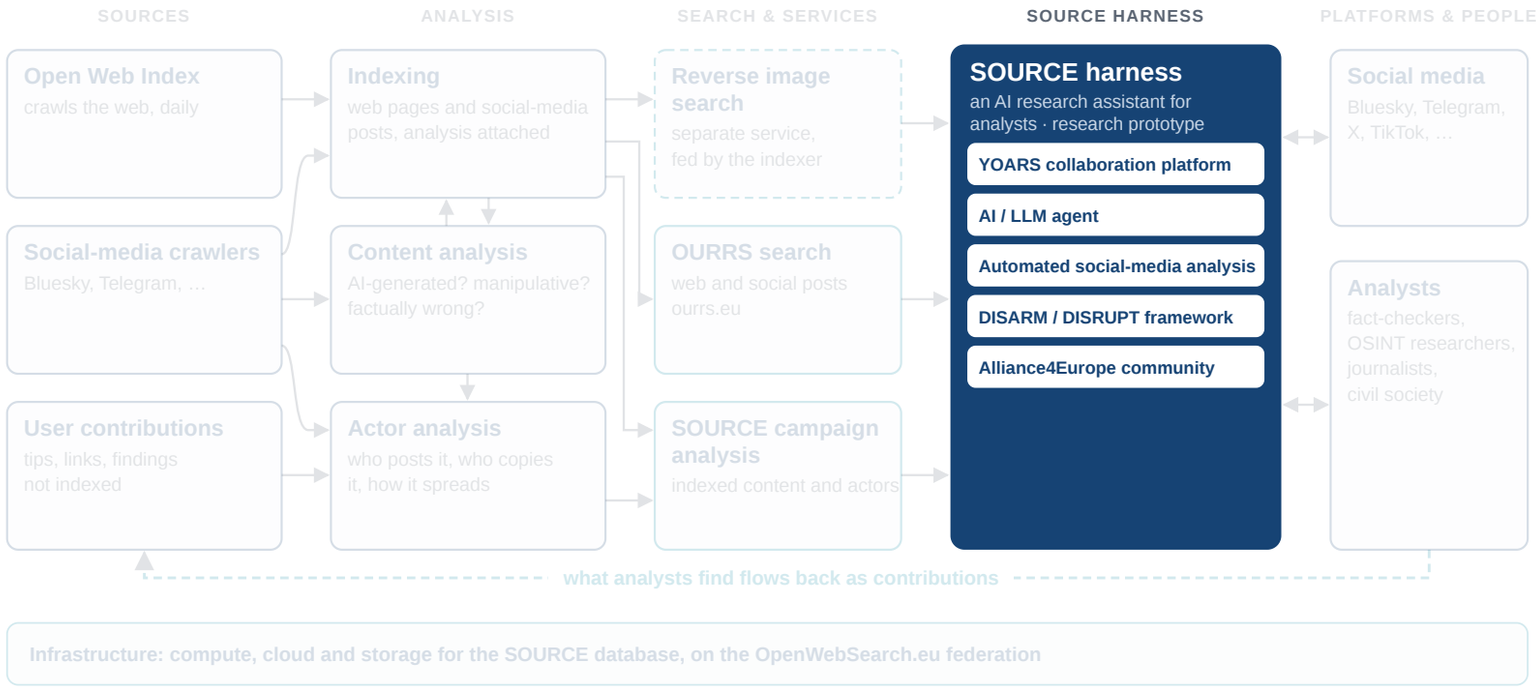
From the open web to the analyst, and back



Infrastructure: compute, cloud and storage for the SOURCE database, on the OpenWebSearch.eu federation

3 · The SOURCE harness

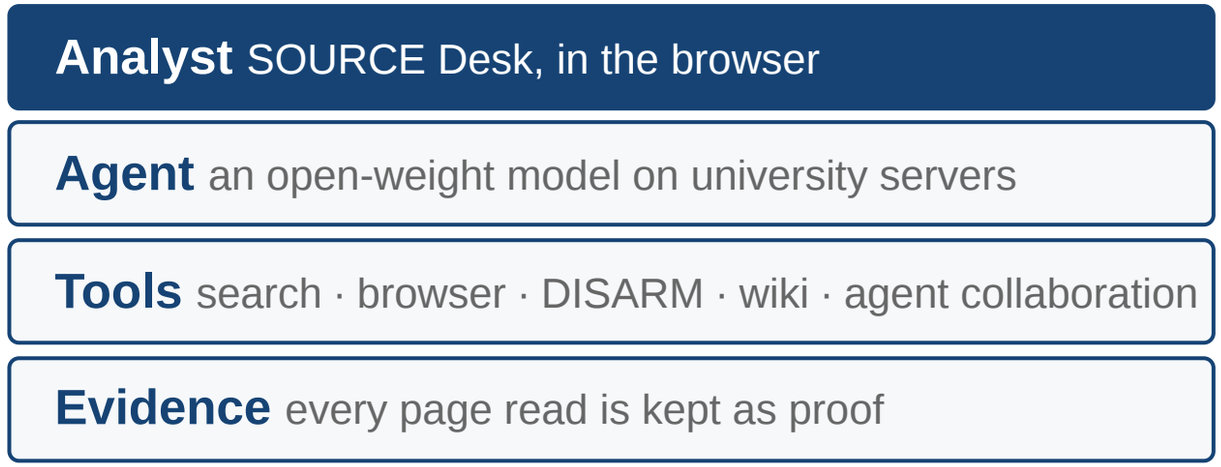
A RESEARCH PROTOTYPE: AN AI ASSISTANT THAT WORKS FOR THE ANALYST, ON THE ANALYST'S MACHINE



What is a harness?

A language model on its own can only write text. A **harness** is everything around it that turns it into a useful and safe assistant:

- the **tools** it may use: search, a browser, DISARM
- the **rules** it must follow, and a guard that enforces them
- a **memory**: the research wiki it keeps
- a **person** who decides, reviews and approves



> Think of the model as the engine, and the harness as the car around it: steering, brakes, and a driver.

An investigation, step by step

1
Ask
a claim, a hashtag, an account

→

2
Search
127 M posts and the web

→

3
Read
the platforms, read-only; keep proof

→

4
Map
behaviour to DISARM techniques

→

5
Write
pages on actors and narratives

→

6
Collaborate
YOARS: with colleagues and their agents

→

7
Review
the analyst checks and decides

> The assistant does the legwork: searching, reading, filing, cross-referencing. The **judgement** stays with the analyst.

DISARM / DISRUPT: a shared language for influence operations

DISARM is an open framework that describes disinformation campaigns the way cybersecurity describes attacks:

- **Red**: what the attacker does, in phases, tactics and techniques ("create fake accounts", "amplify with bots", …)
- **Blue**: what defenders can do against each technique

DISRUPT Toolkit (led and launched by Alliance4Europe), builds on DISARM, and adds the operational side: a community toolbox of measures to stop an operation, from preparing evidence to disruption and mitigation.

391
techniques in 16 tactics

140
countermeasures

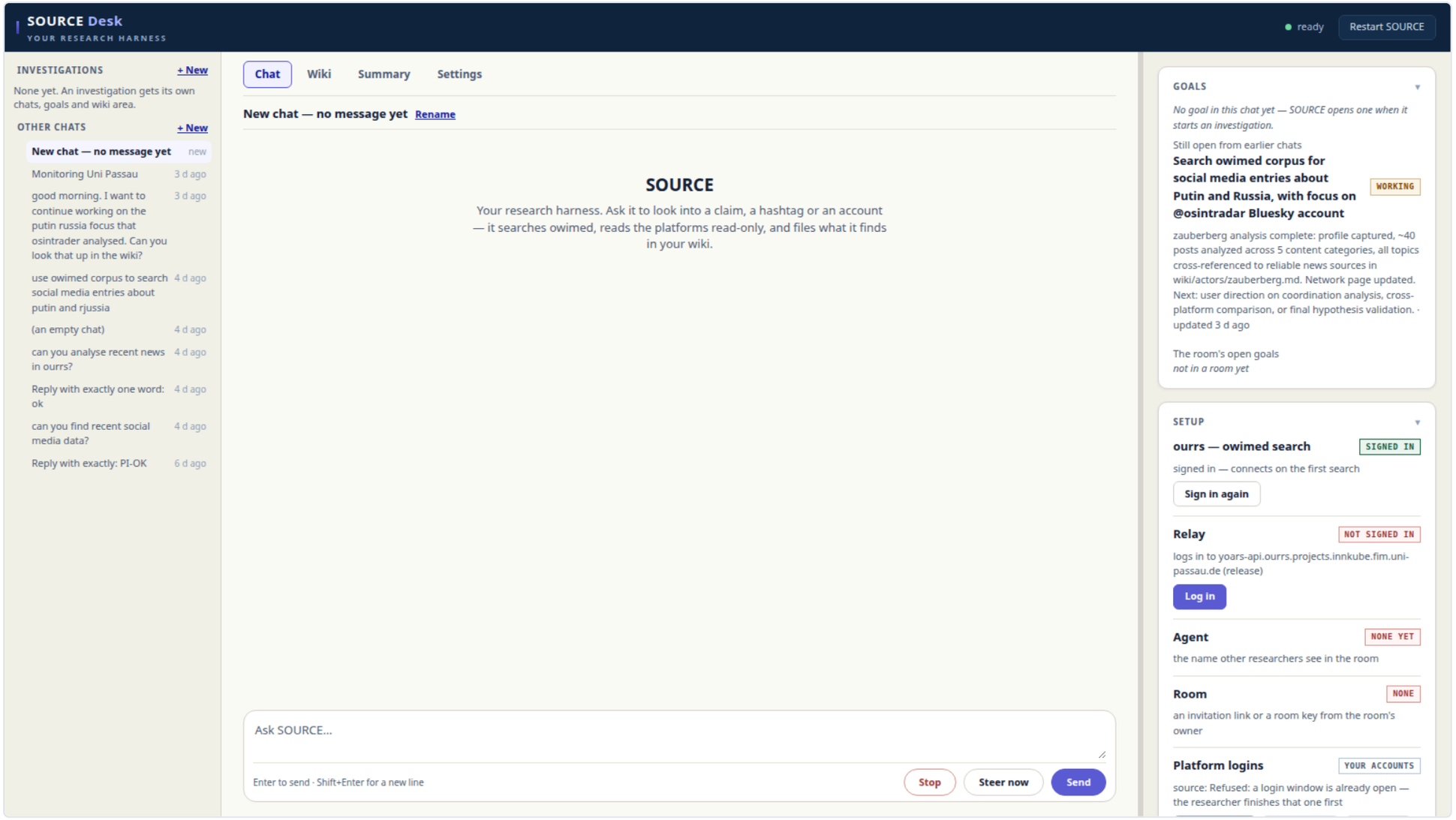
129
documented incidents

DISARM Foundation, DISARMframeworks (CC BY-SA 4.0) · Alliance4Europe, DISRUPT Framework, alliance4europe.eu/counter-disinfo/disruption-framework

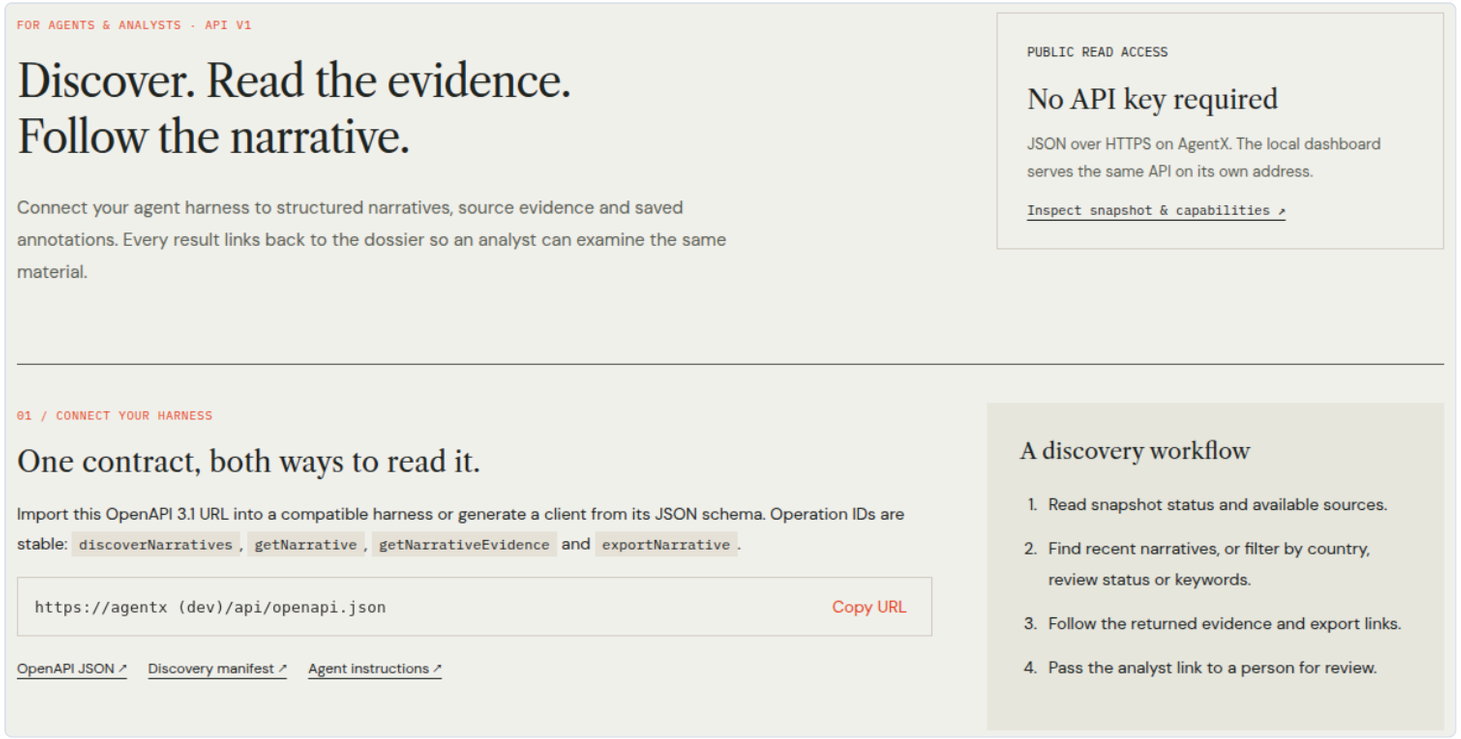
4 · The SOURCE Desk

SCREENSHOTS OF THE RESEARCH PROTOTYPE, AND A DEMO

The SOURCE Desk



Discover: narratives from SOURCE Discovery



agentx (development instance), discovery API page, October 2026.

SOURCE Discovery crawls social media using agents to discover narratives and read the evidence behind them (currently only X). The harness uses it as a tool, `source_discover`.

- → read the snapshot status and available sources
- → find recent narratives, by country, review status or keywords
- → follow the evidence and export links
- → pass the analyst link to a person for review

> Answers are **leads**, not findings: the harness treats them as untrusted.

What it writes: a research wiki

SCHEMA.md EDITABLE Edit

How this wiki works

This folder is a research wiki about possible disinformation campaigns, kept by an agent for the researcher who runs it. It follows Karpathy's "LLM wiki" pattern: **raw sources that never change, pages the agent maintains on top of them, and a check that keeps the two honest.** Open the folder in Obsidian (or any markdown editor) to read it; links, backlinks and the graph work there.

If you edit pages in Obsidian, set it to write the links this wiki uses: Settings → Files & Links → turn `Use [[Wikilinks]]` **off**, and set **"New link format" to "Relative path to file"**. `lint` reports a `[[wikilink]]`, because nothing outside Obsidian can follow one.

Layout

path	what	who writes it
`raw/`	captures: what was read, exactly, with URL, time and SHA-256	`source_capture` / `source_snapshot` / `source_search` / `source_fetch` only — **never edited**
`annotations/`	which DISARM technique a passage of a capture shows, and why — one file per capture, beside `raw/`	`disarm_annotate` only — **never edited**
`wiki/campaigns/`	one page per suspected coordinated campaign	the agent
`wiki/actors/`	accounts, channels, outlets, organisations	the agent
`wiki/narratives/`	recurring claims and framings	the agent
`wiki/incidents/`	one bounded event: a burst, a coordinated push, a hoax	the agent
`wiki/<section>/index.md`	one line per page in that section	the agent, with every new page
`disarm/`	the DISARM framework, imported at a pinned commit	nobody — re-imported, never edited
`index.md`	the entry point	the agent keeps the counts and highlights current

What it writes: a research wiki

wiki/actors/osintradar.md

EDITABLE Edit

kind	actor
title	OSINTRadar (@osintradar.bsky.social)
status	hypothesis
updated	2026-09-27
disarm	["T0119.002", "T0143"]

OSINTRadar (@osintradar.bsky.social)

Summary

OSINTRadar is a Bluesky account with 11.7K followers and 12.6K posts that specializes in open-source intelligence reporting on the Russia-Ukraine war, Middle East, Europe, East Asia, and South Caucasus. The account posts frequent, time-stamped updates covering diplomatic statements, military operations, sanctions, and geopolitical analysis — primarily sourced from mainstream outlets (Reuters, Wall Street Journal, Washington Post, Politico, CBS News) and official government statements. The account also maintains a Telegram channel (@t.me/OSINTRadar05) and accepts donations via PayPal and Ko-fi.

Profile

Platform: Bluesky (@osintradar.bsky.social)
Followers: 11.7K
Following: 803
Total posts: 12.6K
Bio: "RussiaUkraine war|Middle east | Europe|East asia| South Caucasus"
Secondary channel: Telegram (t.me/OSINTRadar05)
Funding: Donations via PayPal (paypal.me/osintradar) and Ko-fi

Recent Posts (captured 2026-09-26)

The profile snapshot below shows posts from approximately the last 24–48 hours. Key Russia/Ukraine-related content:

Diplomatic & Political Statements

"Putin only needs to declare victory and go home" — attributed to Kit Kellogg, with analysis that Russia is not capable of capturing all of Ukraine (capture)
Zelenskyy's call for Trump to activate the Lindsey Graham Act against Russia, plus additional European sanctions (capture)
Sergey Lavrov stated nothing new was achieved during meeting with German Foreign Minister (capture)
Lavrov at UN: "We see signs of neo-Nazism spreading among EU and NATO member states, including in Germany" (capture)
Lavrov at UN demanding release of Maduro and his wife (capture)

What it writes: a research wiki

wiki/narratives/osintradar-russia-ukraine-aggregation.md

EDITABLE Edit

kind	narrative
title	OSINTRadar — Russia/Ukraine Geopolitical News Aggregation
aliases	[]
platforms	["bluesky", "telegram"]
actor	OSINTRadar
created_at	2026-09-27
updated	2026-09-27
status	hypothesis
sources	
DISARM	[]

OSINTRadar — Russia/Ukraine Geopolitical News Aggregation

Summary

OSINTRadar (@osintradar.bsky.social / @OSINTRadar05 on Telegram) is a geopolitical news aggregation account with approximately 11,700 followers on Bluesky and an associated Telegram channel. It posts 100+ times per day, curating and reposting news from mainstream sources (Reuters, Wall Street Journal, Washington Post, CBS News, Politico) with minimal editorial commentary.

Content Profile

The account's content breaks down into several categories based on a 24-hour sample captured on 2026-09-26:

Category	Approx. Frequency	Examples
Russia-Ukraine military updates	Very high	Ukrainian drone strikes on Russian refineries, territorial advances, Russian strikes on Ukrainian cities
Russian official statements (quoted)	High	Putin quotes, Lavrov UN statements (neo-Nazism in EU, "cannon fodder" narrative)
Western government/military aid	High	USAID contracts, Patriot missiles, US-Poland base
Trump administration news	Medium	Iran ceasefire rejection, China-Xi diplomacy, G20 invite controversy
Other geopolitics	Medium	Japan-Russia tensions, Middle East (Houthis), Cuba
Fundraising solicitations	Low (1-2/day)	PayPal, Ko-fi donation links
Cross-platform promotion	Low	"Join me on Telegram" pinned post

It learns, under supervision

good morning. I want to continue working on the putin russia focus that osintrader analysed. Can you look that up in the wiki? Rename

Bluesky reads	`source_search(account=...)` works, `source_fetch(profile)` works	8s rate limit between calls; feeds are refused; only public profile/post pages	Rate-limited `source_fetch` on 3 accounts in one session
DISARM mapping	`disarm_guide` phase/tactic scoping, `disarm_lookup` definitions	Quote-matching fails when captures use smart quotes (") vs ASCII (")	6 annotation retries per technique before finding correct offset
Wiki writes	Schema is well-defined	Frontmatter fields (kind, title), capture paths (`../` depth), unsourced claims, invalid sections, DISARM code lint rules	9 lint findings on first try; needed 3 rounds of fixes
Cross-referencing	Manual topic extraction → source mapping was thorough	No tool to help match content topics to reliable news anchors	Purely manual

Skill Proposals

1. Update `mcp-ourrs` — Add Search Fallback Patterns

The current skill covers the serialization bug but doesn't address **relevance filtering** (nuggets returning semantically matched but topically irrelevant results) or **Bluesky-specific search patterns**.

2. `disarm-annotation` — Systematic DISARM Mapping

This skill codifies the DISARM evaluation → lookup → quote extraction → annotation workflow, with the offset-based quote matching pattern.

3. `wiki-ingest` — Wiki Page Creation & Lint-First Pattern

This skill codifies the correct frontmatter, section structure, and capture-path patterns that pass lint on first try.

4. `bluesky-analysis` — Bluesky Account Behavioral Analysis

This skill codifies the analysis patterns we developed for Bluesky accounts: posting cadence, engagement metrics, amplification networks, and cross-platform behavior.

The index has an invalid status for zauberberg. Let me verify and fix:

Analysis of Our Work & Skill Proposals

Here's what I've done:

Retrospective

Categor	What Worked Well	What Caused Retries	Frequency

After an investigation the agent reviews its own work and proposes skills.

Appearance

The font, size and line spacing of this page. They apply at once, need no restart, and are kept in this browser only.

FONT: System | SIZE: Normal | LINE SPACING: Normal

Skills

What SOURCE may follow beyond its brief. SOURCE can draft a skill (`skills/<name>/SKILL.md`); only you approve it. An approval covers exactly what you saw: an edit makes it a draft again. An MCP override (`mcp-<server>`) replaces the harness's own help for that server. Changes apply when SOURCE restarts.

bluesky-analysis APPROVED

Systematic analysis of Bluesky accounts: posting patterns, engagement metrics, amplification networks, cross-platform behavior, and critic mapping

Review | Edit | Revoke

disarm-annotation APPROVED

Systematic DISARM technique mapping: phase evaluation, definition lookup, offset-based quote extraction, and annotation — avoiding Unicode/smart-quote mismatches

Review | Edit | Revoke

mcp-ourrs — MCP override for ourrs APPROVED

Optimized search across SOURCE's ourrs MCP server with corpus routing, serialization-workaround, and relevance fallbacks

Review | Edit | Revoke

wiki-ingest APPROVED

Wiki page creation that passes source_wiki_lint on first try — correct frontmatter, sections, capture paths, DISARM annotations, and section indices

Review | Edit | Revoke

The analyst reviews each skill and approves, edits or revokes it.

Live demo

> Open an investigation · ask about an account or a claim · watch it search, read and file · open the wiki page it wrote

Where we are, and what comes next

A research prototype

A first technical idea, running in the lab:

- the Desk, a read-only browser and its guard
- search over web and social-media posts via ourrs.eu
- DISARM tools, annotations and a research wiki
- skills proposed by the agent, approved by people

Next: with the community

- discuss the approach and its rules with analysts; it needs the community's approval
- first trials with Alliance4Europe analysts
- DISARM/DISRUPT guiding questions reviewed by experts
- tools from the partners: coordination detection, image fingerprints, link provenance

SOURCE
Desinformation erkennen.
Demokratie schützen.

UNIVERSITY OF PASSAU
Faculty of Computer Science and Mathematics

UNIKASSEL VERSITÄT

open search foundation

Irz

Alliance 4Europe

source-project.de · info@source-projekt.de

Appendix

DESIGN RULES OF THE PROTOTYPE, AND A FIRST INTERNAL TEST

Design rules of the prototype

BUILT INTO THE HARNESS TODAY; TO BE DISCUSSED AND AGREED WITH THE COMMUNITY

- ✓ **Every claim cites a capture.** A check refuses wiki pages that do not.
- ✓ **DISARM codes come from the DISARM tools**, never from the model's memory.
- ✓ **Runs as you, on your machine.** What it collects stays there.
- ✓ **New skills need a human.** The agent proposes; only the analyst approves.

- ✗ **No posting, liking, following or messaging.** The browser is read-only.
- ✗ **No passwords.** The analyst logs in by hand; the agent never sees credentials.
- ✗ **No bulk scraping.** A reading pace per platform: at least 8 s between pages, 400 a day.
- ✗ **No attribution by resemblance.** Looking like a known incident is not proof.

SOURCE harness: agent brief (spec/brief.md), README, design decisions D1, D7, D32 (yoars, lane SOURCE, September 2026)

Does it help? A first internal test

An automated benchmark: DISARM documents example incidents with quoted source reporting. We gave the agent **62 of these descriptions**, with the technique codes removed, and asked which techniques each one shows.

Model (open weights)	Exact technique	Technique family
Gemma 4 31B	0.33	0.42
Qwen 3.6 35B	0.29	0.36
Qwen3-Next 80B	0.21	0.27

Micro F1 against 309 gold codes, 26 September 2026.

0

invented codes, in every run

Preliminary, not yet validated by analysts. About a third right is a **helper**, not a judge; the guiding questions go to experts next, then we measure again.